

Northern Trust Asset Management Brand & Messaging Proposal

AUGUST 2026



Ogilvy

Proposed project scope

The Challenge

Northern Trust Asset Management has built strong momentum — including the "If You Know, You Know" campaign — but the business continues to evolve.

NTAM's story hasn't yet been fully connected to the "One Northern Trust" narrative, and there's an opportunity to sharpen NTAM's positioning vs. competitive set and how it ladders up to the enterprise brand.

The Ask

Help NT develop a differentiated NTAM brand and messaging platform by pinpointing where NTAM and competitors position themselves today especially with prospective clients.

Align on the strongest whitespace for NTAM and the applicability of the IYKYK creative platform while ensuring the message complements the WM and AS BUs as well as Corporate.

Then develop a messaging system that can be activated by teams at all levels of communication and channels.

Approach

Phase	Phase I — Research, Analysis & Recommendation (8 weeks)	Phase II — Messaging Architecture Framework (6 weeks)
Key Activities	A. Assess 10 competitors and the NTAM brand strategies, messaging and creative expression. Conduct a maximum of 10 interviews with NTAM leadership. B. Develop alternative positionings based on whitespace and the vision for NTAM moving forward. C. Test with synthetic audiences, built from the three supplied personas and proprietary research. D. Review 3 alternative positioning options, and associated brand attributes, and align on preferred option. E. Define how that positioning connects to the "One Northern Trust" brand (key principles of service, expertise and integrity) & the implications for creative platform development.	A. Facilitate a NTAM x Ogilvy workshop session to present new positioning and explore the range based on this positioning, key audiences and timing around product/service innovations. B. Use this input to build a Messaging Architecture Framework.
Key Outputs	1. Key findings deck that includes NTAM brand & competitive analysis, value proposition assessment and leadership & stakeholder insights. 2. Presentation of findings, alternative positionings, with pros and cons, for Enterprise review and alignment. 3. Final NTAM brand positioning, definition of how this aligns with the overarching Northern Trust brand & recommendation on creative platform (IYKYK or new).	1. A structured workshop to achieve stated objectives. 2. Final NTAM Messaging Architecture Framework & Enterprise Alignment Presentation. 3. Activation & Governance Guide covering audience/capability/product-level guidance, campaign & content application, and usage principles.



Competitive Audit & Stakeholder Insights

Approach

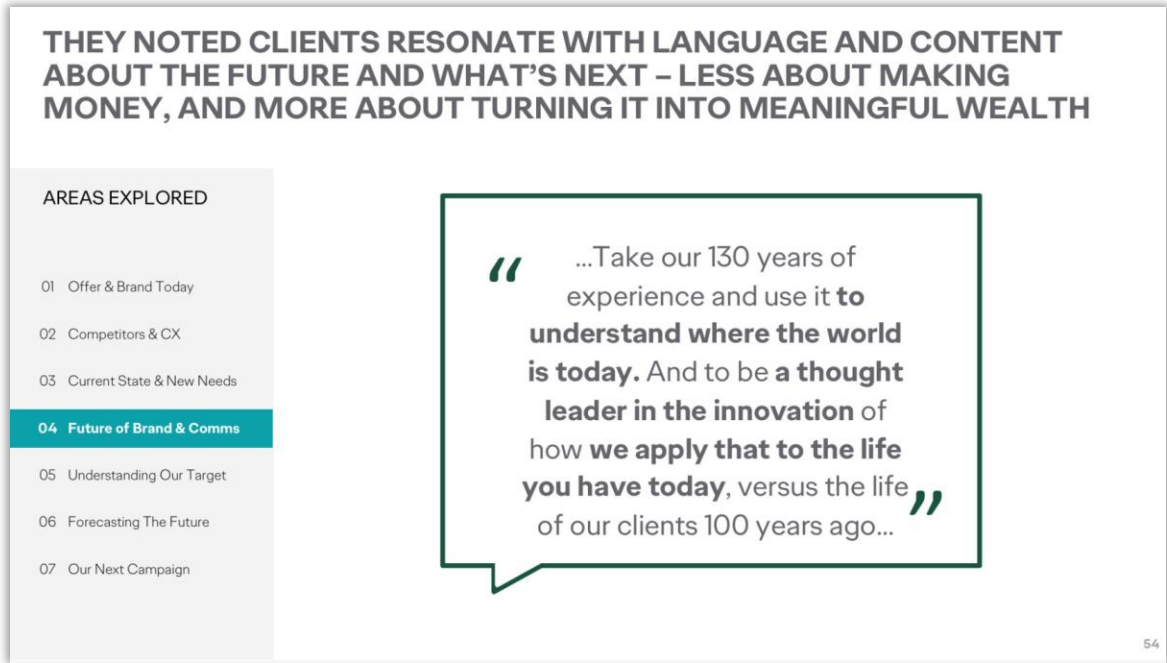
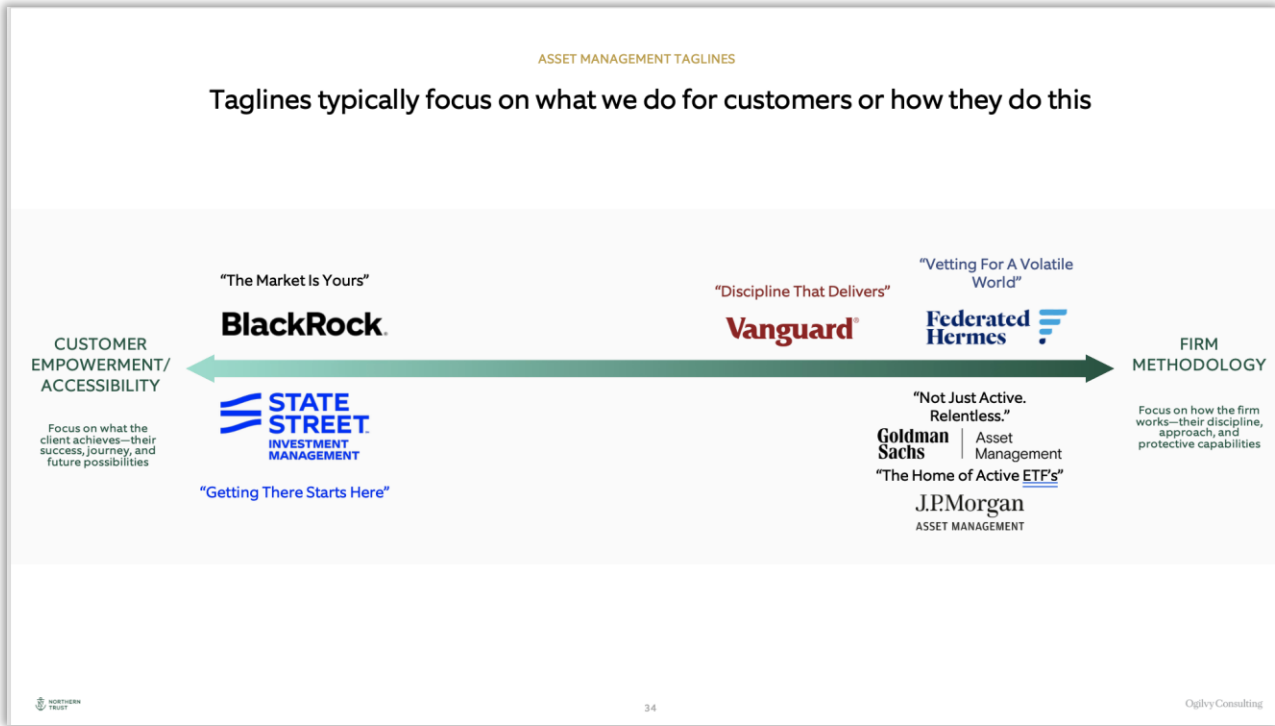
NTAM & Competitive Audit

- Evaluate NTAM and competitors, leveraging last year's work as a starting point.
- Assess each brand’s consistency across audiences plus brand and product-level communication.
- Analyze differentiation and identify whitespaces.

Leadership Interviews & Synthesis

- Prepare discussion guides for stakeholder interviews.
- Conduct interviews.
- Once completed, synthesize leadership input into clear themes, tensions, and decision points to inform the positioning creation.

Deliverable Examples



List of Competitors

2025			
Rank ^Δ		AUM (\$T) ²	Market Share ¹
—	BlackRock ♦	\$14.0	10%
—	Vanguard ♦	\$12.0	8%
—	Fidelity ♦	\$6.6	4%
—	STATE STREET INVESTMENT MANAGEMENT ♦	\$5.7	4%
↑1	J.P.Morgan ♦ ASSET MANAGEMENT	\$4.8	3%
↑2	Goldman Sachs ♦ Asset Management	\$3.6	2%
↓2	CAPITAL GROUP ♦	\$3.3	2%
↑1	Amundi ³ ♦	\$2.8	2%
↓2	BNY INVESTMENTS ♦	\$2.2	1%
↑6	Invesco ♦	\$2.2	1%



Combined AUM of ~\$2.4T
Deal expected to close 4Q26



Value Proposition Assessment

Approach

Assess Current & Proposed Value Propositions

- Evaluate clarity, resonance and competitive differentiation of NTAM's current and proposed value propositions.

Separate the Ownable from the Expected

- Distinguish table stakes attributes expected from asset management companies versus genuine differentiators.
- Assess emotional versus functional benefits and where the balance should sit.

Pressure-Test the Evidence

- Assess competitive resonance and the strength of supporting proof points.

Deliverable Examples

Table Stakes vs. Differentiators

Table Stakes — attributes expected within the asset management category

Differentiators — ownable attributes NTAM can credibly claim

Proof Point Strength Audit

- Each claim rated as supported, thin or unsupported
- Prioritises the proof to strengthen before market-facing use



Develop Positioning Options

Activities

Develop Positioning Options

- Based on findings from the competitive landscape and leadership interviews.

Develop Positionings & Synthetic Audiences

- Develop 3 positionings.
- Test and refine positionings based on synthetic audience feedback and identify key brand attributes that support each.

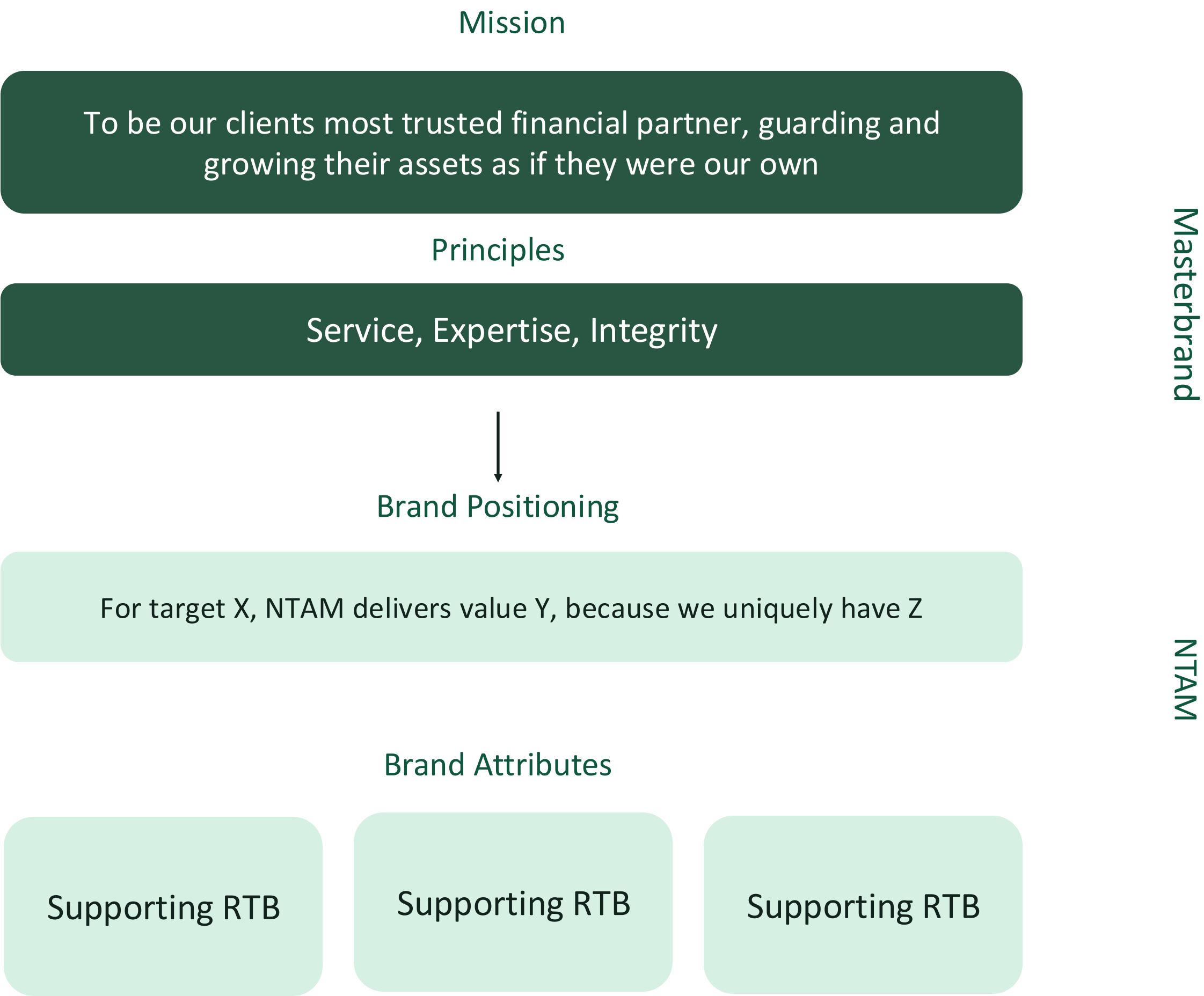
Evaluate the positionings with Enterprise Leaders

- Assess their brand fit, alignment with the NTAM business vision, distinctiveness and credibility.

Define Final Positioning Statement & Attributes

- Land on one recommended positioning statement and supporting brand attributes to carry forward into Phase II.

Deliverable Framework





Positioning Statement Examples

Positioning Statement Construct

- The positioning construct enables us to explore different target attitudes and motivations and ensure we are not targeting a particular mindset within the market, not everyone in the market.
- In simple terms, the brand positioning combines what clients need with the strength you have that competitors can't match.
- Unlike value propositions, they are not tailored to audience segments and are used over a longer period.



Brand Positioning

For people who think and feel their way through the world, Hilton Garden Inn delivers a stay that feels just right on every level and your head and heart are nurtured by your bright-hearted host

Brand Attributes

Hardworking heartfelt
service

Intuitive welcoming
spaces

Elevating uplifting
comforts



Brand Positioning

For those seeking reliable, tried-and-true transport, Ford provides the automotive you've always known in addition to mobility solutions because Ford is known for revolutionizing the way the world moves

Synthetic Audience Development

Created from the three personas supplied

Built out through proprietary expert interviews

Recommend we supplement the current personas with expert interviews that explore the alternative positioning statements. Proposal includes audience definition, source assembly, the build and validation of the audiences, and the human review of it.

- 1

Institutional Asset Owners Pensions, Defined Contributors, Endowments And Foundations, Union Plans, Insurance Institutions
- 2

Financial Intermediaries Wirehouses, Independent Broker-dealers, RIAs, Independent/Hybrid Advisors, Regional Firms, Platform-based Advisors
- 3

Relationship advisors Wealth Advisors / Financial Advisors, Senior Portfolio Advisors, Wealth Strategists, Relationship Managers within NT Wealth

The choice is how we interview the experts

Both routes produce the evidence base. What separates them is how much time we get with each expert and our ability to respond in real time to answers.

Two Routes for the Expert Interviews

OUR RECOMMENDATION

	NewtonX	GLG
Method	AI-moderated, text-based	Live, moderated by your Ogilvy team
What you get	Consistent, comparable answers, quickly	The unplanned follow-up, the hesitation, the depth
You can listen in	No	Yes
Per interview	\$330	\$2,000
15 interviews	\$4,950	\$30,000

Interview fees are out of pocket — billed to actuals.

Both options will require a small increase in Ogilvy hours.

Whitespace & Opportunity Framework

Approach

Map the category

- Surface category overlaps — the claims, territories and codes the competitive set holds in common.
- Identify overused claims and territories where differentiation is no longer available.

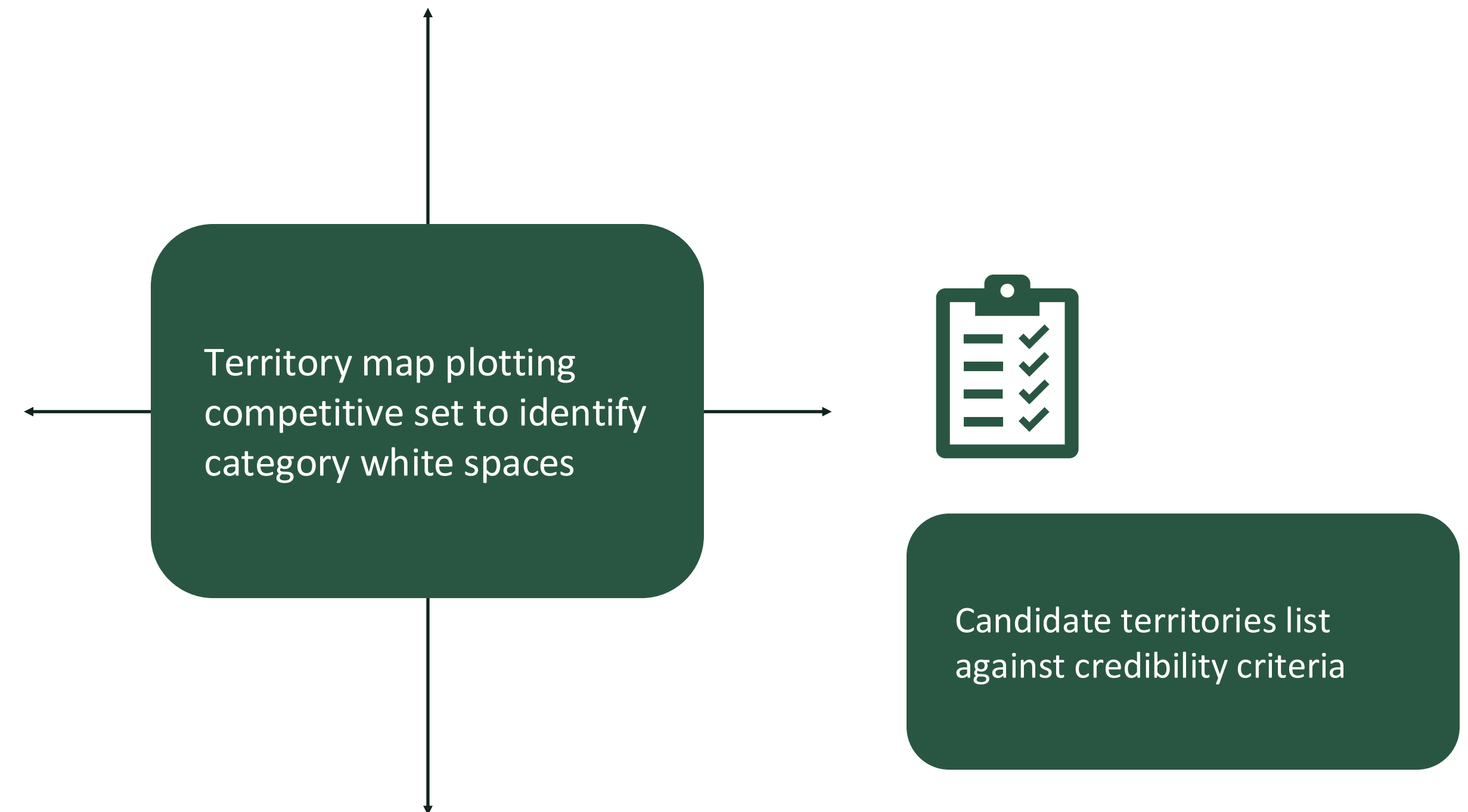
Identify the opening

- Surface under-leveraged territories and the emotional, functional and narrative spaces available in the category.

Test what NTAM can credibly own

- Define defensible areas of differentiation NTAM can credibly own, assessed against current proof, business ambition and competitive vulnerability.

Deliverable Examples



How We Get to a Recommendation

Approach

Assess all three, not only the preferred one

Every option is scored against the same four criteria, so the recommendation is a comparison, not a preference.

Where each score comes from

Audience size and differentiation from the audit and category data.

Perception shift and credibility from the interviews and the audience testing.

What Northern Trust sees

The full scoring, the reasoning behind each mark, and one recommendation with its trade-offs stated.

Assessment Framework

Criterion	Option 1	Option 2	Option 3
Size of audience			
Relevance of audience			
Degree of differentiation			
Shift from current perception of NTAM			
Credible reason to believe to leverage			
Synthetic Audience Feedback			

Criteria confirmed with Northern Trust before scoring.

Messaging Workshop

Approach

Workshop Objectives

- Share project findings and the recommended NTAM positioning.
- Gather input on NTAM business priorities, key audiences, and product and key service innovations over the next 3–5 years.
- Pressure-test proposed messaging territories and surface where flexibility is needed.

Decision Points

- Which brand attributes to carry into future communications.
- Which hero solutions and products lead the messaging.
- Where messaging should flex by audience.

Illustrative Discussion Prompts

- If NTAM could only be known for one thing in the next 3–5 years, what is it and which of our attributes could a competitor claim tomorrow with equal credibility?
- Which solutions carry growth, and which carry the story? Are they the same ones?
- For each priority audience, what does this group need to believe that the others don't?

Facilitation Framework

- Ogilvy to provide pre-read framework to all workshop participants to ensure everyone comes to the table with considered discussion points.
- Ogilvy facilitates a face-to-face session lasting 2.5 hours, using physical stimulus to provoke discussion.
- Stimulus takes the form of recognisable worked examples, a question paired with an illustrative answer, to give participants a concrete starting point rather than an open brief.

Outputs & Documentation

- Documented session outputs covering agreed direction, open questions and points of disagreement.
- Synthesis feeding directly into the messaging architecture framework.

*Workshop objectives, discussion prompts and outputs are indicative and subject to change based on discovery findings and evolving business priorities.

Draft Agenda

<i>Time (2.5 hours)</i>	<i>Activity</i>
15 minutes	Welcome & objectives
30 minutes	Project findings, new NTAM Brand Positioning & NTAM business priorities in the next 3–5 years
30 minutes	Messaging: Brand Attributes to communicate in the next 3–5 years & key NTAM paid/owned/earned touchpoints
30 minutes	Messaging : Hero solutions/products to communicate in the next 3–5 years
30 minutes	Messaging: Tailoring to audience specific needs
15 minutes	Next steps



Enterprise Brand Architecture & Alignment

Approach

Define the Relationship

- Recommend how NTAM positioning should connect to the broader corporate structure and the “One Northern Trust” brand system.

Clarify Differentiation Across Business Units

- Provide guidance on business unit differentiation and shared territories across Asset Management, Wealth Management, Asset Servicing and Corporate.*
- Identify what is shared at enterprise level and what is specific to NTAM.

Reduce Fragmentation

- Establish the principles that keep expression consistent across business units over time.

* Input required: existing positionings for Wealth Management and Asset Servicing to be supplied by Northern Trust.

Deliverable Examples

Layered Alignment Diagram

Corporate Principles — service, expertise, integrity

Business Unit Positionings — Asset Management, Wealth Management, Asset Servicing, Corporate

NTAM Expression — positioning, attributes and messaging

Shared vs. Specific Territories

- Shared: enterprise principles and the “One Northern Trust” brand system
- Specific to NTAM: positioning, attributes and messaging expression



Messaging Architecture Framework & Governance Guides

Approach

Deliverable Examples

Messaging architecture

- Translate the approved positioning statement down through brand-level messaging, hero solutions, and product-specific communication — building the connective tissue from "who NTAM is" to "what NTAM offers."

Build Audience-Specific Messaging

- Tailor by 3 key audiences as defined in the personas.

Validate Framework with Stakeholders

- Share the completed messaging architecture with NTAM leadership to confirm it reflects workshop input and is ready to guide activation.

NORTHERN TRUST
ASSET MANAGEMENT

IYKYK GUIDANCE FRAMEWORK

Asset management brand communication

IYKYK idea and tagline is used

- Build unified awareness of NTAM as a sophisticated, institutional partner for discerning investors
- No specific product focus. If fund focused, it should help build the asset management brand

Hero solutions

The IYKYK idea and tagline is used

- Drive awareness and consideration for new or sophisticated or unique solutions from NTAM
- Messaging reveals non-obvious value propositions and NTAM expertise

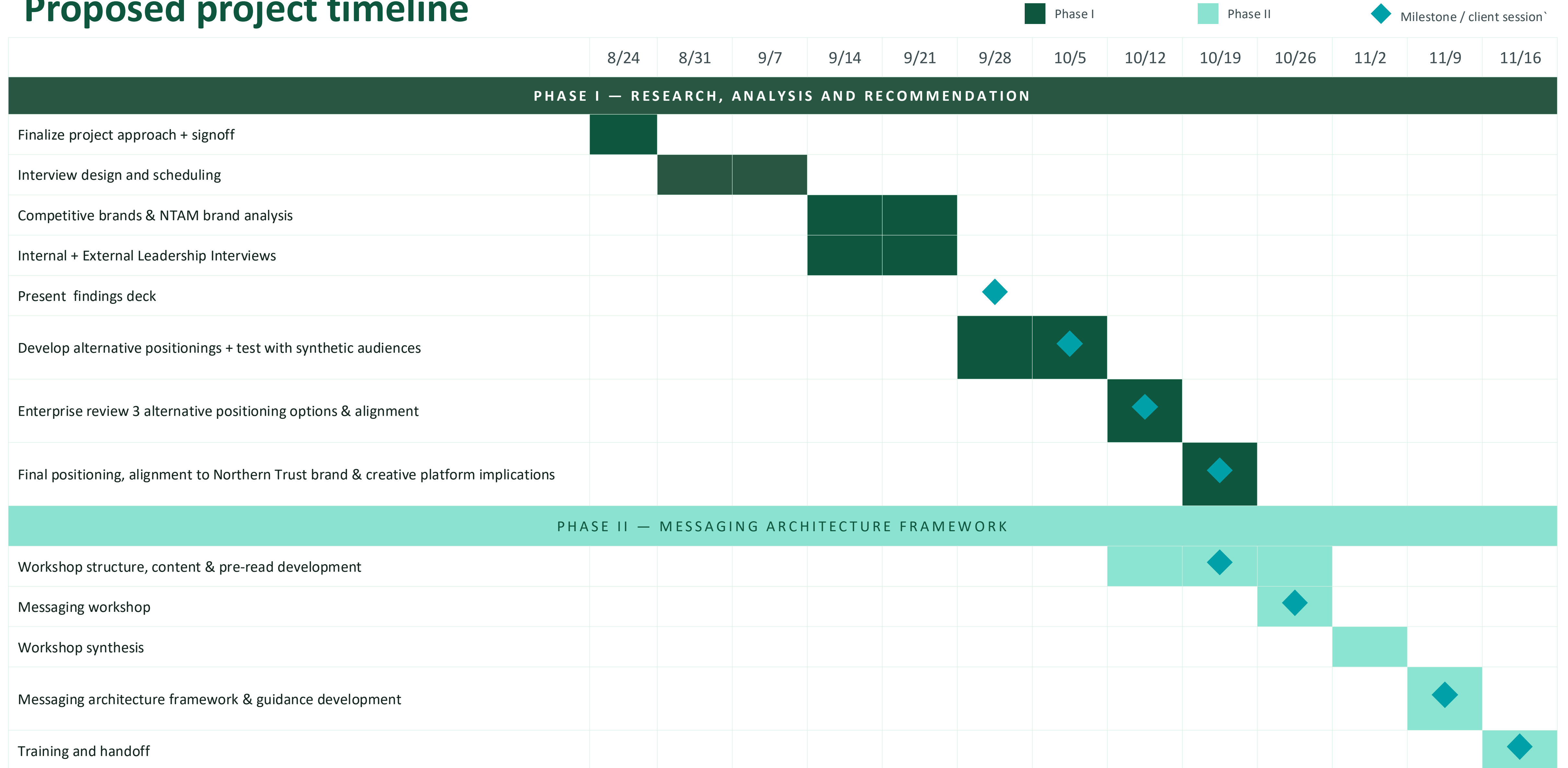
Other communication

The IYKYK idea and tagline is used

- The solution communicates audience nor sophisticated

IYKYK COMMUNICATION GOVERNANCE	
Does your communication fit any of these scenarios? If yes, IYKYK is <u>not</u> appropriate:	Examples (to fill)
Mass-Market Communications <i>Rationale: When speaking to broader non-expert audiences</i> • Communications where the messaging focus is simplicity and accessibility • Market Commentary prioritizing broad accessibility, crisis clarity, regulatory transparency or educational fundamentals	• NTAM Blog Series like "The Weekender" and "Point of View" • NTAM Personnel
Basic Product Specifications <i>Rationale: Pure data presentation, no narrative or differentiation story</i> • Standard fact sheets focused solely on characteristics (ticker, inception date, benchmark etc) • Product lineup brochure simply listing all available funds without methodology focus • Fund allocation tables	• NTAM Fund Lineup Page • General Sales Enablement • Pitch decks • Fact sheets • Brochures • Q&As • Fund Profiles, • Case Studies and Use Cases
Transactional Communications <i>Rationale: Objective is immediate action/information</i> • Rate sheets and pricing tables • Order forms and transaction confirmations • Account opening materials	• NTAM Client onboarding materials
Instructional & Educational Content <i>Rationale: Primary goal is clarity and teaching, not implying insider knowledge</i> • "Introduction to ETFs/Mutual Funds" educational series • Basic investment concept explainers for less experienced investors • FAQ's explaining product mechanics • Glossary of investment terms	• NTAM Website Weekly Investment Updates • "Liquidity Link Monthly" LinkedIn Series • Newsletters
Compliance & Regulatory Communications <i>Rationale: Requires transparent and directness</i> • Regulatory filings and formal notifications • Risk disclosure statements • Legal or regulatory change summaries • Privacy Policy Updates	• NTAM Compliance & Regulatory Client Emails • Annual/semi-annual reports • Prospectuses • Supplements • Client letters

Proposed project timeline



Project Budget Summary

Option 1: NewtonX Research (AI Moderation) - \$324,638

	Phase I (8 weeks)	Phase II (6 weeks)
Consulting/Strategy	\$208,809	\$96,879
Account Services	\$5,940	\$3,060
Out of Pocket	\$4,950	\$5,000
Total Cost	\$219,699	\$104,939

Option 2: GLG Research (Live Moderation) - \$354,938

	Phase I (8 weeks)	Phase II (6 weeks)
Consulting/Strategy	\$214,059	\$96,879
Account Services	\$5,940	\$3,060
Out of Pocket	\$30,000	\$5,000
Total Cost	\$249,999	\$104,939

Assumptions:

Phase 1 OOP costs cover external research (Option 1 via NewtonX, Option 2 via GLG). Both options cover costs for 15 interviews. Audience build and validation covered for both routes; GLG option adds additional time for Ogilvy to facilitate interviews.

Phase 2 OOP costs for both options cover \$5k for T&E for workshop travel, stimulus production & workshop materials (if needed).

OOP costs are billed to actuals.

Your Team

Account



WHITNEY BURTON
Executive Group Director



KELLI MARCIN
Account Supervisor

Consulting / Strategy



CAROL STICKLER
Global Consulting Principal



CHRIS COTTER
Group Experience Strategy Lead



FRANCES HANSON
Global Consulting Director



ANITA CLIFFORD
Global Consultant



LAMIA BUSHRA
Global Analyst

Thank you



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